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ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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Research & Development Cell (RDC)

Annual Report 2025–2026

1. Introduction

The Research & Development Cell (RDC) of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur, is committed to promoting a culture of research, innovation, creativity, academic inquiry and knowledge creation among faculty members and students. The Cell works towards strengthening research capabilities and encouraging research-oriented teaching and learning in alignment with NEP 2020 and UGC guidelines on Research & Development Cells.

2. Objectives

During the academic year 2025–2026, the RDC focused on:

- Promoting research awareness among faculty and students.
- Encouraging quality research publications and academic writing.
- Motivating faculty members to identify research areas and prepare research proposals.
- Facilitating participation in seminars, conferences, workshops and Faculty Development Programmes.
- Encouraging interdisciplinary and collaborative research.
- Promoting innovation, entrepreneurship and problem-solving approaches.
- Creating awareness about research ethics, plagiarism and responsible conduct of research.
- Encouraging faculty members to explore funding opportunities and consultancy activities.

3. Major Activities

During 2025–2026, the RDC facilitated and supported various research-oriented activities, including:

- Research awareness and orientation among faculty members.
- Encouragement for publication of research papers in reputed journals.
- Faculty participation in seminars, conferences, workshops and FDPs.
- Guidance for preparation and submission of research proposals.
- Promotion of interdisciplinary research across academic departments.
- Encouragement of student participation in project work, research-based learning and innovative activities.
- Awareness regarding Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), patents, copyrights and plagiarism.
- Promotion of collaboration with academic institutions, industries and other organizations.
- Documentation and monitoring of research-related achievements of faculty members.

4. Research Publications & Academic Contributions

Faculty members were encouraged to contribute to the research ecosystem through:

- Research articles and scholarly publications.
- Books and book chapters.
- Conference papers and presentations.
- Participation in academic and research forums.
- Research-based student projects.
- Interdisciplinary academic initiatives.

The RDC maintained and encouraged systematic documentation of research publications, participation, projects and other scholarly achievements for institutional quality enhancement.

5. Research Capacity Building

The Cell encouraged faculty members to continuously enhance their research competencies through:

- Research methodology programmes.
- FDPs and workshops.

- Training in academic writing and publication practices.
- Awareness of research funding opportunities.
- Use of digital research resources and scholarly databases.
- Guidance on research ethics and academic integrity.

6. Innovation, IPR & Entrepreneurship

The RDC worked in coordination with institutional initiatives such as the Institution Innovation Council (IIC), IPR Cell and Entrepreneurship/Innovation Committee to encourage innovation and entrepreneurial thinking among students and faculty.

Activities focused on developing creative ideas, problem-solving skills, innovation awareness, intellectual property awareness and opportunities for converting innovative ideas into useful solutions.

7. Research Infrastructure & Resources

The College continued to strengthen its research-support ecosystem through departmental laboratories, library resources, digital learning resources, DELNET facilities, ICT infrastructure and access to academic resources. Faculty and students were encouraged to make effective use of available facilities for academic and research activities.

8. Research Collaboration & Outreach

The RDC encouraged academic interaction and collaboration with universities, colleges, research institutions, industries and other organizations wherever appropriate. Such initiatives were aimed at promoting knowledge exchange, interdisciplinary learning and research with relevance to societal and community needs.

9. Outcomes

The major outcomes of RDC initiatives during 2025–2026 include:

- Increased awareness of research and innovation among faculty and students.
- Greater encouragement for research publications and academic presentations.
- Improved participation in research-oriented seminars, workshops and FDPs.
- Promotion of interdisciplinary and collaborative research.
- Increased awareness of IPR, research ethics and academic integrity.
- Encouragement for research proposals, funding opportunities and consultancy.

- Strengthening of research documentation and institutional evidence.

10. Future Plan

The RDC proposes to further strengthen the institutional research ecosystem by focusing on:

- Increasing quality research publications.
- Encouraging funded research projects and consultancy.
- Organising research methodology and academic writing programmes.
- Promoting IPR, patents and innovation.
- Developing interdisciplinary research initiatives.
- Strengthening industry and academic collaborations.
- Encouraging student research and innovation projects.
- Creating greater awareness of national and international research opportunities.

11. Conclusion

The Research & Development Cell of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur continued its efforts during 2025–2026 to create a supportive and sustainable research environment. Through faculty development, research awareness, academic collaboration, innovation and systematic documentation, the RDC aims to strengthen the College's commitment to quality education, research excellence and meaningful societal contribution.

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